

Sherlock Holmes Hidden London

10 Canonical Locations · 3 Hours · Baker Street to Southwark

221B Baker Street is the tourist trap. The real Sherlock Holmes London is still there — gas-lit alleys, Victorian opium den addresses, the Strand hotel where Holmes staged his death. Walk where Conan Doyle actually set the stories.

YOU SAVE: £167 vs guided tours

■ WHAT THIS GUIDE SAVES YOU

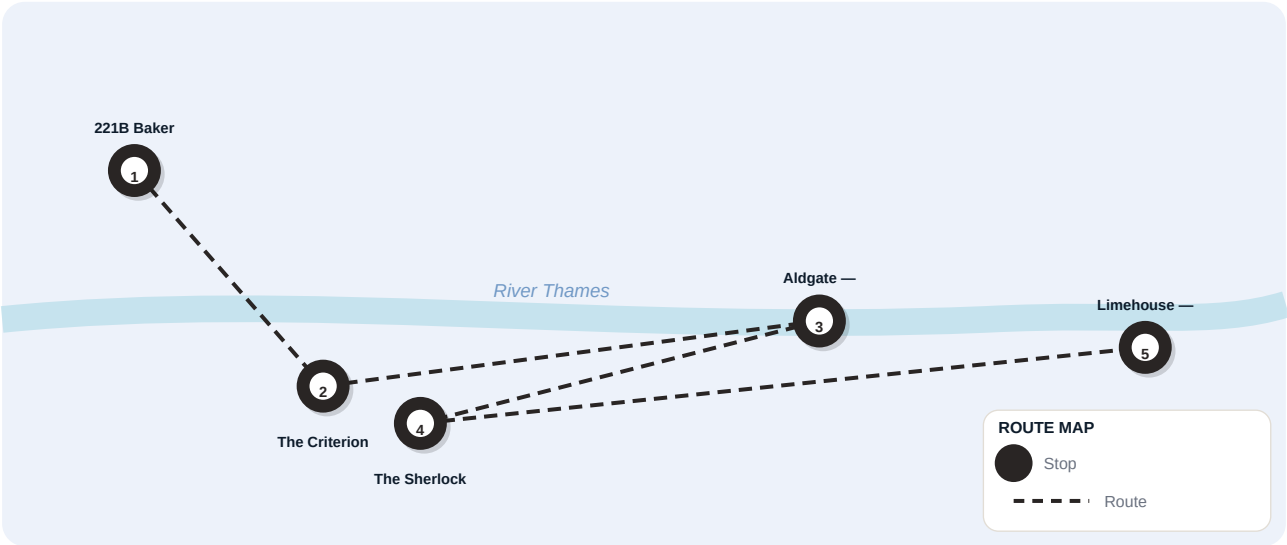
Retail price of this guide
£12.99

Equivalent guided tours
£180

YOUR SAVING
£167

ROUTE INFO	
■ Start	221B Baker Street — The Sherlock Holmes Museum (Baker Street)
■ End	Limehouse — The Opium Den Streets (Limehouse)
■ Duration	3 Hours
■ Transport	From central London: Zone 1–2 daily cap £8.10 covers all stops
■ Total Cost	Guide: £12.99 · Most stops FREE · See individual stop costs

SCHEMATIC ROUTE MAP



PRO TIPS — READ BEFORE YOU GO	
■ Best day	Tuesday–Thursday for fewer crowds at almost every location

■ Saving	Pre-book anything with tickets — usually £2–4 discount per person
■ Offline map	Download Google Maps offline before leaving your hotel
■ Transport	Use Contactless card — automatic daily cap (Zone 1: £8.10, Zone 1-2: £10.10)
■ Members only	This guide is exclusive to London Lens lifetime subscribers

■ COMPLETE STOP GUIDE — SHERLOCK HOLMES HIDDEN LONDON

Follow stops 1→5 in order for the best walking route. Each card includes insider tips, savings info, and the cheapest transport option.

1

221B Baker Street — The Sherlock Holmes Museum

Baker Street · Daily 9:30am–6pm

■ START HERE

HIDDEN TIP

The actual 221B Baker Street is now the Abbey National bank headquarters (originally) — the museum is at 239 Baker Street but numbered 221B by special permission. The free exterior photograph is identical to the paid one inside. But do go in — the Victorian recreation is genuinely excellent.

■ SAVING

Book online — no discount but saves queuing. The FREE exterior photo is

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Baker Street (2 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Interior recreation of the sitting room (worth the £16)
- ✓ The detective agency in the basement
- ✓ Find the police blue plaque on the correct wall

■ Best: Tuesday–Thursday to avoid weekend queues

AVOID:

Weekends July–August — 45 min queue

★★★★■

£16 museum / free outside

2

The Criterion Restaurant — Where Watson Met Holmes

Piccadilly Circus · Mon–Sat 11:30am–11pm

■ 25 min or tube

HIDDEN TIP

In A Study in Scarlet, Stamford introduces Watson to Holmes at the Criterion Bar. The actual restaurant still exists and the Victorian gold mosaic ceiling is original. You can walk in, stand at the bar, order a coffee, and be standing where Watson first heard of Holmes. The ceiling alone is worth a visit.

■ SAVING

Bar visit: £5 coffee. Sherlock Holmes tours: £22pp. Saving: £17

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Piccadilly Circus (2 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Stand at the bar where Watson met Stamford
- ✓ Look up — the original 1870s gold mosaic ceiling
- ✓ A coffee here is £5 — expensive but in a genuine Canonical location

■ Best: Midday on a weekday for the bar (no reservation needed)

AVOID:

Dinner — very expensive. The bar for a drink or coffee is perfect.

★★★★★

Free to visit · £££ to dine

3



Aldgate — The Sign of the Four Locations

■ 30 min or tube

Aldgate · Always accessible

HIDDEN TIP

The Sign of the Four opens in Pondicherry Lodge — based on a real house in Upper Norwood. But the Aldgate area is where Holmes tracked Jonathan Small. The Victorian docklands atmosphere of Wapping and Shadwell survives almost intact.

■ SAVING

Sherlock Holmes walking tours: £22. This route: free. Saving: £22

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Aldgate (Zone 1) or Wapping Overground
Cost: Zone 1–2

DO THIS:

- ✓ Wapping High Street — Victorian warehouses identical to Holmes era. great area to explore freely
 - ✓ The Captain Kidd pub (Wapping) — atmosphere perfect for Holmes
 - ✓ The Thames foreshore at low tide — mudlarking like in the stories
- Best: Anytime — these are street locations

AVOID:

★★★★■

Free

4



The Sherlock Holmes Pub — Northumberland Street

■ 25 min from Aldgate

Charing Cross · Mon–Thu 10am–11:30pm, Fri–Sat 10am–midnight, Sun 10am–11pm

HIDDEN TIP

Northumberland Street is the Northumberland Hotel of The Hound of the Baskervilles. The Sherlock Holmes pub here has a recreation of the Baker Street sitting room behind glass on the first floor — accessible for free. The pub itself has genuine Victorian fittings and reasonable prices.

■ SAVING

Free entry to the recreation. Near the hotel from Baskervilles. Saving vs guided

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Charing Cross (3 min walk) or
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ First floor: the recreated Baker Street room (free to view) Post-theatre evenings — rammed
 - ✓ The pub memorabilia collection
 - ✓ A drink on Northumberland Street — genuinely Canonical
- Best: Midday for the first floor room viewing

AVOID:

★★★★■

Free entry



Limehouse — The Opium Den Streets

■ DLR from Bank

Limehouse · Streets always accessible · The Grapes: daily 12–11pm

HIDDEN TIP

In *The Man with the Twisted Lip*, Holmes disguises himself in an opium den in Upper Swandam Lane, Limehouse. The actual street (now Narrow Street) still has original Victorian warehouses and the same river atmosphere. The Grapes pub (1583) was Dickens's local and has barely changed.

■ SAVING

East London history tours: £18. Free
self-guided: saving £18

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Limehouse DLR (5 min walk)
Cost: Zone 2 — ~£3 from central London

DO THIS:

- ✓ Narrow Street — original Victorian warehouses
- ✓ The Grapes pub (1583) — oldest pub atmosphere in East London
- ✓ The Limehouse Basin — unchanged from Holmes's era
- Best: Evening for the Victorian dock atmosphere

AVOID:

Arriving by car — parking impossible

★★★★★

Free

QUICK REFERENCE CARD — CUT OUT OR SCREENSHOT

Summary of all stops for easy on-the-go reference.

#	Name	Area	Walk	Cost	Tube	Rating
1	221B Baker Street — Th...	Baker Street	Start here	£16 museum	Baker Street (2 mi	★★★★■
2	The Criterion Restaura...	Piccadilly Circu	25 min or tube	Free to vi	Piccadilly Circus	★★★★★
3	Aldgate — The Sign of ...	Aldgate	30 min or tube	Free	Aldgate (Zone 1) o	★★★★■
4	The Sherlock Holmes Pu...	Charing Cross	25 min from Al	Free entry	Charing Cross (3 m	★★★★■
5	Limehouse — The Opium ...	Limehouse	DLR from Bank	Free	Limehouse DLR (5 m	★★★★★

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